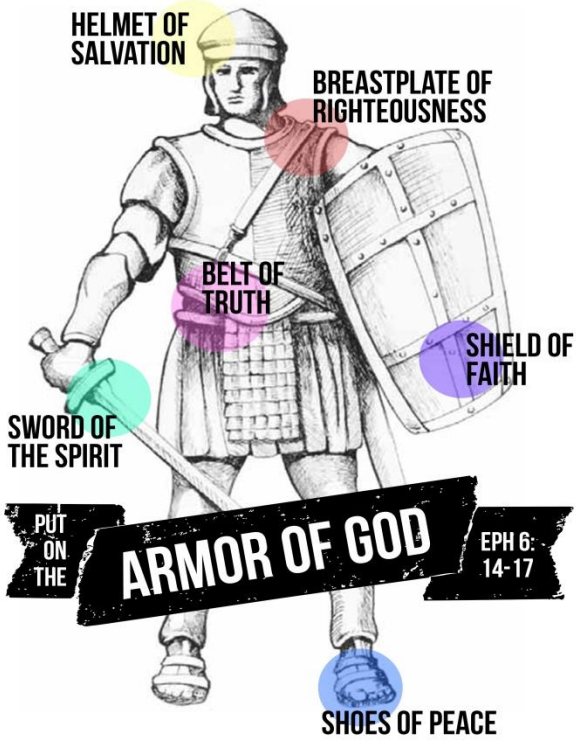
Are You Clothed with the Armor of God?



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Are You Clothed with the Armor of God?

Ephesians 6:10-13 "Finally, be strong in the Lord and in his mighty power. **Put on** the full armor of God so that you can **take** your stand against the devil's schemes. For our struggle is not against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the powers of this dark world and against the spiritual forces of evil in the heavenly realms. Therefore, **put on** the full armor of God, so that when the day of evil comes, you may be able to stand your ground and after you have done everything to stand." (emphasis added)

God tells us that His armor is necessary to stand against the enemy's schemes and when we have it on we will stand in victory. He says that we are to be strong **in Him** and **in His mighty power,** not in our own power. We are in a spiritual war, but we do not have to defeat the enemy because Jesus has already defeated him. Jesus has given us everything we need for life

and godliness. However, we do need to enforce the victory that Jesus died to give us and one of the ways of enforcing our victory is to be fully clothed with our heavenly armor. We do have to stand our ground and not allow our enemy to bully us into thinking that we are defeated. How do we do this? The only way we can stand against his schemes is to be fully clothed with the armor of God.

God tells us that we are in a spiritual war. He says that our struggle is not against people (flesh and blood) but against the rulers, authorities and powers of this dark world and spiritual forces of evil. In other words, it is against the devil and his demons.

Satan has tactics that each piece of the armor will defeat.

It is vitally important for us to have each piece of the armor on in order to walk in victory over Satan's tactics.

So, what are the pieces of the Armor of God and how do we put them on so that we are fully

clothed? When we are clothed, Satan has no power over us. He cannot defeat us when we are fully clothed.

Ephesians 6:14-18 "Stand firm then, with the belt of truth buckled around your waist, with the breastplate of righteousness in place, and with your feet fitted with the readiness that comes from the gospel of peace. In addition to all this, **take up** the shield of faith, with which you can extinguish all the flaming arrows of the evil one. **Take** the helmet of salvation and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God. And pray in the Spirit on all occasions with all kinds of prayers and requests. With this in mind, be alert and always keep on praying for all the saints." (emphasis added)

In Ephesians 6:13 the NIV says to **put on** the full armor of God. The KJV says to **take unto you** the whole armor of God. Verses 16 and 17 repeat the word "take". So what does this word "take" mean?

I looked up the word “take” in the Greek and it means to receive up, take in, take unto and take up.

This is a very important word for us to understand so that we will know how to be clothed with the armor of God.

To take something is to receive it. In other words, to put on the armor of God is to take it unto ourselves and receive it **internally**. Putting on the armor of God is not something we do **externally** just by saying “I put on the belt of truth and the breastplate of righteousness, etc”**.** Just saying these words does not clothe us with the armor of God. We can say “I put on the breastplate of righteousness” and not even believe we are the righteousness of God in Christ Jesus. In order to be clothed faith must be involved. When we get the truth of God’s Word into our hearts, it will come out of our mouth because we believe it and that’s when we are truly clothed with God’s armor. Truth must first be planted in our hearts (internal). So the armor of God is put on internally.

Jesus has bequeathed His armor to us. Each piece of the armor of God is exactly what it is. It is **God's armor** that we **take** unto ourselves and **receive** so that we can stand firm against the enemy. Each piece of the armor is so closely intertwined because **each piece is a part of Jesus Himself**. At salvation we receive Jesus into our heart (our life). He comes to live on the inside of us. Stop and think about that. It is not an external clothing but one that takes place on the inside of us as we begin to understand and **receive revelation** of what each piece of the armor of God is to us.

We simply need to understand what we have as a child of God so that we can walk fully clothed with Jesus Himself.

Ephesians 3:26-27 "You are all sons of God through faith in Christ Jesus, for all of you who were baptized into Christ have **clothed yourselves with Christ**." (Emphasis added)

At salvation, when we were immersed into Christ Jesus, our spirit man was supernaturally

clothed with Jesus. Our spirit man is already fully clothed with Jesus but since we are a three part being, our soul and body are in the process of being clothed with Jesus. We have been made in God's image. God is a three part being. God is a spirit. We are a three part being as well. We are a spirit, we possess a soul (which consists of our mind, will and emotions which flow out of our heart) and we live in a body.

There are 7 pieces of armor which are all weapons we can use against the enemy in order to stand on the solid rock of Jesus Christ.

These weapons are not physical but spiritual, for our warfare is spiritual in nature. None of these pieces of armor are for our back, only our front, which, I believe, means we are never to retreat from the enemy but stand our ground and fight the good fight of faith with them firmly in place. In order for every piece to be in place, our faith must be involved. So let's look at them individually.

1. **Truth**

Jesus is the way, the **truth** and the life (see John 14:6).

Satan is the opposite. He is a liar and the father of lies. He is also a deceiver. **So he uses lies and deception as tactics to try to keep us from knowing and walking in Truth.**

Truth is our protection from the lies and deception of the enemy. Truth will enable us to stand our ground against these tactics of the enemy but we must know Truth and receive Truth.

As a believer, how do we take unto ourselves Truth?

John 14:6 says that Jesus is Truth. This is who He is. Jesus is the embodiment of Truth. Truth already lives in our spirit because Jesus who is Truth lives in our spirit. So our spirit is already clothed with Truth but our soul is in the process of being clothed. Our mind (which is part of our soul) needs to be renewed with Truth (the Word of God). In other words, as we get our minds renewed with the Word and apply it to

our daily lives, we will walk in Truth that sets us free from the lies and deception of the enemy. We will begin to think like Jesus thinks and act like Jesus acts.

Just by saying "I put on the belt of truth" does not mean you have the belt of truth on if your mind has not been renewed with Truth. The more Truth we grasp or grab ahold of, the more victory we will walk it. When we know the Truth we will not buy into the lies and deception of the enemy.

We have the belt of truth on only to the degree that we know and believe truth.

Putting on the Belt of Truth is getting to know Jesus personally and intimately through the Word of God because He is Truth. He is the Word. It is all about spending time with Jesus in the Word. We put His Word into our hearts. The Bible says that the Truth shall set us free. It sets us free from the lies and deception of the enemy. It is when we receive, on the inside of us, **revelation of Truth** that we are actually clothed with this piece of the armor to the

degree that we have received revelation. We are being clothed with Jesus Himself, who is Truth to us. We are not just reading words on a page but we are receiving the Living Word (Jesus). The Word is alive and actively working in our lives when we believe it. Even as you read this book, you are being clothed with Jesus as you receive Truth in this Book.

Being clothed with Truth is continuous as we walk with Jesus on a daily basis.

Believing the truth that Jesus is the living Word and spending time with the living Word (the Bible) will break, destroy and free us from yokes of bondage. If we find ourselves in a situation (i.e. sorrow, fear, poverty, sickness, condemnation, depression, confusion, etc.), find out what God's Word says about it and then hold on to Truth. It will bring transformation and pull down the lies and deception of the enemy.

Romans 10:9 says that if you confess with your mouth, Jesus is Lord, and believe in your heart

that God raised him from the dead you will be saved.

If we **believe God's precious promises with our heart**, we will confess them with our mouth and we will have them. We hold on to God's Promises (Truth) by meditating on (thinking about and speaking out) God's Word pertaining to our situation and thanking God for His specific Promises. This is being clothed with Truth. This is taking unto ourselves and putting on the Belt of Truth internally.

2. Righteousness

Jesus is righteous and **He** is our righteousness (see Jeremiah 23:6).

Through Adam we were all born sinners, but through Jesus we were **made** righteous. As believers, Jesus made us righteous by giving us His very own righteousness. We are not **being made** righteous. We are righteous now because we have been given Jesus' righteousness. I am in Jesus and He is in me and He made me righteous. My spirit man is totally righteous in

God's sight. My spirit man is fully clothed with righteousness. I am the righteousness of God in Christ Jesus but my soul may not believe this.

The righteousness that Jesus gives to us is a free gift. It cannot be earned, deserved or merited. It is received by faith. The enemy will try to tell us that we are not righteous because of the way we just acted. **His tactics are to bring condemnation, guilt and shame so that we will not believe that we have been made righteous in Christ Jesus.** He comes to steal our confidence that we are right with God. By doing this, he is trying to rob us of our righteous stance in God by making us think we are not right with Him. This happens in the area of our soul.

We need to believe that we are the righteousness of God in Christ Jesus and that His righteousness is inside of us. This is so very important for us, as believers, to understand and grab ahold of. It is a weapon that we use to stand firm against the enemy when he comes with guilt, condemnation and shame.

Philippians 3:9 “not having a righteousness of my own that comes from the law, but that which is through **faith in Christ**–the righteousness that comes from God and is **by faith.**” (emphasis added)

We receive righteousness **by faith**. We simply believe that Jesus gave us His righteousness. We simply receive it **by faith**. We may not feel righteous or even act righteous but it is **by faith** that we are the righteousness of God in Christ Jesus. We believe what God’s Word says about us **by faith**.

Galatians 5:4-5 “You who are trying to be justified by law have been alienated from Christ; you have fallen away from grace. But **by faith** we eagerly await through the Spirit the righteousness for which **we hope**.” (emphasis added)

Some Christians think that by obeying the law, we are made righteous when, in fact, it is **by faith** that we have been made righteous. When we believe that we have already been made righteous by faith, we will have the hope that

we long for and we will live right. It is our right believing in who we are in Christ that enables us to live a righteous life. We have had it backwards. We think that it is our righteous living that makes us righteous. That's still living under the law. The truth is that **by faith** in what Jesus did for us, we have been made righteous. It has nothing to do with our right or wrong living. It does, however, have everything to do with Jesus and what He did for us. The righteousness by faith is a free gift that comes only through our belief in Jesus Christ. If you want to live right and do things God's way, then **embrace** this truth (that you are the righteousness of God in Christ Jesus) and see the difference it will make in your life. Let go of your self-righteousness and let God truly be your Righteousness.

When we get our minds renewed with the Word of God that we are the righteousness of God in Christ Jesus, transformation will begin to take place in our soul area and we will begin to live a righteous life. **When we believe right, we will live right**. By meditating on this Truth, this Truth is actively working on the inside of us

enabling us and empowering us to live a righteous life. Remember Jesus is Truth. The more Truth we believe and get into our hearts, the more we are being empowered to walk in the victory that Jesus died to give us.

Because Jesus made us righteousness in our spirit, our standing or stance before God is that we are right with Him even though our behavior, which stems from our soul, is not always right. So our standing with God is right but our mind needs to be renewed with Truth so that our behavior will also become more and more in line with how God thinks and acts. Our spirit man is 100% righteous. It is our right standing with God that saves us, not our behavior. Our behavior does not save us. We are saved by grace through faith in Jesus Christ. This is what makes us righteous and in right standing with God. Does God want us to have right behavior? Absolutely! We are on a journey with Him for the rest of our lives and it is up to us how quickly we get our minds renewed with Truth that sets us free. Getting our minds renewed does not make our spirit man anymore righteous but it will benefit us

hugely and enable us to walk in more and more victory that Jesus died to give us. **It will enable us to stand against the tactics of the enemy.**

When we choose not to renew our minds and choose to continue in our wrong behavior (sin), sin does have consequences. These consequences don't come from God, they come from the sin in our lives. If we commit adultery, the consequences of that sin is that our spouse may divorce us and our children may cut themselves off from us. If we steal, the consequences of that sin could be imprisonment. These are only a couple of examples.

The scriptures refer to two kinds of righteousness. There is righteousness that comes by faith and is a free gift from Jesus, and there is self-righteousness. A self-righteous person thinks they are better than others. They tell people to live one way while they live another way. They do things for their own recognition. Their heart motivations are wrong. We can be self-righteous if we think we can get to heaven by simply being a good person and by

doing good works. We can be self-righteous by thinking that we will become more righteous by our good works. This actually means that we are good enough to make it to heaven by our own efforts of goodness, rather than by accepting what Jesus did for us on the cross. This way of thinking actually is implying that Jesus died on the cross for nothing.

When we are self-righteous, we think we have this breastplate of righteousness in place when we really don't. We think we are protected by this piece of the armor, but we really aren't.

Christians can be walking in a mixture of Jesus' righteousness that comes by faith and self-righteousness that comes by works. I did this for many years until I came to understand the Truth. My spirit man was clothed with Jesus' righteousness but my soul was not.

The moment we believe in Jesus Christ as our Savior and Lord, we have been made righteous in our spirit man. We are no longer separated spiritually from God. Our minds, however, need to be renewed with this Truth so that when the

enemy brings condemnation, guilt and shame and tries to tell us we are not righteous, we will not believe him.

Romans 8:1 says that there is no condemnation for us who are in Christ Jesus. Are you in Jesus? Do you believe in Him as your personal Savior and Lord? If your answer is "Yes" then believe that Jesus has defeated the enemy by giving you the gift of "no condemnation". This Truth will empower you to stand against the enemy's tactics. When you believe that you are the righteousness of God in Christ Jesus, it will empower you to live right. You may get the victory little by little but keep believing right and right living will be the result of your right believing.

I urge you to get firmly established that you are righteous in Christ. Meditate upon this Truth until you believe it. This is putting on the Breastplate of Righteousness.

Just like Jesus is our Truth, He is also our Righteousness. Do you see how these two pieces of the armor work together?

3. **Peace**

Jesus is Peace. He is our Prince of Peace.

Because Jesus lives in us, as believers, His Peace also lives in our spirit man but our soul needs to receive His Peace on a daily basis.

We are to fit our **feet** with the readiness that comes from the Gospel of Peace. What does this mean and how do we do this?

Isaiah 55:12 "You will go out in joy and **be led forth in peace**; the mountains and hills will burst into song before you, and all the trees of the field will clap their hands" (emphasis added).

I believe "feet" symbolizes us moving forward in our walk with God. God wants us to be led, or to move forward, by His peace; to walk in His peace. He wants us to make decisions from a peaceful mind and heart and not from an anxious mind or out of anxious emotions. As we are led by peace, we will make right choices and

right decisions. When we move out of God's Will, we will experience a lack of peace.

Please don't be led by your emotions as this will bring turmoil to you. The Bible tells us to be led by the Holy Spirit.

God wants us to pray about our decisions before we make them and then wait until He instructs us. Our problem is that we think we are not hearing from God but when God tells us it is time to move, we will hear Him. If we don't hear Him the first time, He will speak to us again and again. If He is not speaking, then it is not time to move. Hold your ground and do not move forward until you hear from Him. He will always lead you by His peace. In other words, you will have peace in your heart that you heard from God and know how you are to move forward. Waiting upon God for His instructions will protect you from the enemy's tactics.

The enemy's tactics are to get us to rush and run ahead of God so that we will make wrong decisions and suffer the consequences of those wrong decisions. They

can be decisions that will cause you financial and emotional distress, etc. It could be rushing into a relationship or a marriage that isn't of God. It can be making a wrong career choice, etc. The enemy will rush you and try to make you think that you will miss out if you don't do it now. He will bring fear to get you to move quickly. If you feel rushed or fear, then do not move. Stand your ground against the enemy's tactics. Let peace be your umpire.

How do we keep peace in our lives?

Isaiah 26:3 "You will keep in perfect peace him whose mind is steadfast, because he trusts in you."

KJV says "whose mind is stayed on thee".

This scripture tells us to keep our minds focused on God and He will keep us in perfect peace. Simply trust Him, do what He tells you to do and He will do the rest.

Philippians 4:6-7 "Do not be anxious about anything, but in everything, by prayer and

petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the **peace of God**, which transcends all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus." (emphasis added)

This scripture says we are to cast our cares upon the Lord. Cast all your anxiety, worry and fears upon the Lord. Pray about everything, put them in God's hands and He will give you peace. The peace He gives may be to simply stand your ground and wait. Don't take matters into your own hands and think that God is not speaking to you. He will speak when He wants you to move. If you have prayed and you aren't hearing anything from God, then don't move. When God speaks, He is always on time. We need to trust Him.

John 14:27 "Peace I leave with you; my peace I give you. I do not give to you as the world gives. Do not let your hearts be troubled and do not be afraid."

The word "peace" in this scripture is the word "shalom" in Hebrew. In addition to meaning

peace, calm and quietness of heart, mind and emotions, it also means wellness (health), prosperity, rest, safety, welfare, wholeness and completeness. **It denotes a state of untroubled, undisturbed well-being.** This is the peace that Jesus gives to us.

Jesus gives us His very own peace. He gives us the peace He enjoyed while on earth. He gives us everlasting peace. He does not give as the world gives. The world gives and takes away but Jesus only gives. He will not take His peace from us (our spirit man). However, if we move out of God's will, we are choosing to move out of His Peace. Our spirit man is still at peace with God because we still believe in Him as our Savior and Lord but our soul is not at peace. If we stay in God's will, we will stay in God's Peace.

We are not to let our hearts be troubled and afraid which will rob us of peace. The devil wants to steal our peace. We need to let go of the things in our lives that our troubling us and depend on God to take care of the situation i.e. marriage, children, finances, jobs, health, etc.

We do this by keeping our eyes on Jesus and declaring His promises over our situation.

1 Peter 5:7 “Cast all your anxiety on him because he cares for you.

It is God’s Word, the Gospel of Peace, that we **take** and receive into our hearts that will bring us peace.

We can have God’s peace in the middle of a huge storm in our lives by staying focused on Jesus. Peter walked on water because he had his eyes on Jesus even though there was a huge storm all around him. Peter began to sink when he took his eyes off of Jesus and looked at the storm around him but even then he called out to Jesus to save him and Jesus immediately responded to his request.

You may have given in to the enemy’s tactics to rush into something and now you find yourself in a bad situation. Pray and ask God to pour out His grace in your mistakes and allow His peace to guide you.

There is one further thing I would like to mention regarding this piece of armor. As we wait upon the Lord and when He brings Peace in a given situation on how to move forward, we will trample upon our enemy. This Peace will cause us to be resolute like David who ran towards Goliath (the giant in his life) with his trust in God alone. David had God's peace and he was moving forward with a Godly confidence to trample upon Israel's enemy. His confidence was in God, not in himself. David did not wait for Goliath to come after him. David ran towards Goliath trusting in God to defeat him because David knew his God. David was operating in faith. He came against Goliath in the name of the Lord Almighty, the God of the armies of Israel and he declared that the Lord would hand Goliath over to him and the whole world would know that there is a God in Israel (see 1 Samuel 17:45-46).

When we have waited upon the Lord and have His peace in moving forward, we will have a Godly confidence that God is in it with us. When we move forward and the road appears to be difficult, we will always be able to fall back on

what God spoke to us and know that He is in it with us. i.e. if He has moved you forward to be a missionary, the road ahead may not always be easy but you have a Godly confidence that you are in His perfect will and that He is with you.

When we are led by Peace, we will not give into the enemy's tactics to run ahead of God but will wait upon Him. Even in our waiting, we will have Peace.

Just like Jesus is our Truth and our Righteousness, He is our Peace.

4. **Faith**

Jesus is our faith.

We live by the faith of the Son of God. We live by His faith. Let's look at that in this next scripture.

Galatians 2:20 "I am crucified with Christ: nevertheless I live; yet not I, but Christ liveth in me: and the life which I now live in the flesh I live **by the faith of the Son of God**, who loved

me, and gave himself for me. (KJV) (emphasis added)

Did you see that we live by the faith of the Son of God?

Are you starting to see that these pieces of the armor are all about who Jesus is to us as children of God? He is Truth. He is our righteousness. He is our peace. He is our faith.

Acts 3:16 "By faith in the name of Jesus, this man whom you see and know was made strong. It is Jesus' name **and the faith that comes through him** that has given this complete healing to him, as you can all see." (emphasis added)

This scripture says that faith comes through Jesus.

Romans 10:17 "So then faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the word of God." (KJV)

Jesus is the Word of God. As we hear and continue to hear the Word, faith arises within

our soul. Therefore, faith comes through the Word of God who is Jesus.

Remember that the Armor is for us **to stand our ground against the enemy and his tactics**. Jesus already defeated him in His redemptive work but we have to use faith to believe that he is already defeated. When we **believe** he is defeated, we will be able to stand against him. **It's not faith in ourselves and in our ability to stand against him but faith in Jesus, who is our faith**. It is faith in the Word of God and the promises that are ours in Christ Jesus. Our faith is in Him not in ourselves. I have faith in the fact that God is faithful even when I'm not faithful.

The enemy's tactics are to make us think that it is our faith; that we just don't have enough faith; that we are not faithful. The enemy puts the emphasis on us; that we don't have enough faith to defeat him. The Truth is that we already have Jesus' faith in our spirit man. The Truth is that Jesus has already defeated the enemy for us. We just have to believe this. By getting our minds renewed

with the Word of God, Jesus' faith will arise within our soul.

I now live by the faith of the Son of God. I live by His faith. His faith is present in my life as I stay in the Word and stay focused on Jesus and what He did for me.

Our faith should not be in what we can do. Our faith should be in Jesus and in what He has already done for us on the cross. He did it all. When He said on the cross "It is finished" He already made available to us every provision that we will ever need. We just need to **take** it in and receive it. God is no respecter of persons. What He did for one, He did for all. It is up to us now to believe it and receive it. We receive the finished works of Jesus Christ by faith. We receive what grace has already made available to us by faith. Everything in this Christian life is by faith in Jesus Christ and what He has already accomplished for us.

The woman with the issue of blood was so determined to be healed by Jesus that she pushed her way through the crowds to get close

enough to Jesus so that she could touch the hem of His garment. She knew that her healing depended upon her touching Him. She had to get close to Him in order to touch His garment. In her weakness, she pressed through the crowd. It was her weakness and the crowd that were trying to prevent her from touching Jesus. What is in our lives that is trying to prevent us from touching Jesus; from getting close to Him? Her faith was in Jesus and His ability to heal her. Are we pressing through **with His faith** (which comes from the Word of God) to receive what has already been made available to us or are we giving up and allowing doubt and fear to rob us? She could have given up. She could have said: it is too hard, the crowd is too big and I am too weak but she kept her eyes on Jesus and pressed through. Her faith was in Jesus to heal her.

I already mentioned that the enemy's tactics are to make us think that we just don't have enough faith; that we are not faithful enough but there is more. He uses **fear, doubt and unbelief** to keep us from walking in the faith that comes through the Word of God.

Jesus tells the synagogue ruler in Mark 5:36 to not be afraid, but to just believe.

The Bible says that perfect love casts out all fear (see 1 John 4:18). It is the Truth that God loves us unconditionally, intentionally and eternally that will cast out the lies of fear. Find scriptures on God's love for you and meditate on those scriptures daily and fear will be cast far from you. Get rooted and grounded in God's love for you. Every time the enemy brings fear declare that you are deeply loved by God.

We have authority over unbelief, doubt and fear.

Say: I bind you fear, doubt and unbelief in Jesus' Name. I will not believe your lies. I **have been** healed by the wounds of Jesus and, therefore, by faith I am healed now. Thank you Jesus for the victory.

Isaiah 53:5 says that we are healed now. We may not see the manifestation yet but God's Word says our healing is a finished work. We

just need to believe what God's Word says and not what we see in the natural.

Faith will move mountains. Faith enabled the woman with the issue of blood to push through the crowds. She was still living under the Old Covenant Law. Today we are living under the New Covenant of Grace. We receive by faith what Grace has already made available to us. Faith brings a determination to receive what is ours in Christ. Jesus has already made salvation, healing, deliverance, provision and wholeness available to us. He already did it all in His redemptive work. Now it is up to us to simply believe this and receive His finished works by faith.

Of course, we can't do any of this in our own power and strength. We need the help of the Holy Spirit. We need Him in our lives. Jesus knew this and that's why He sent His Spirit to be with us and to help us. Please acknowledge His Presence in your life and acknowledge your need of Him. He is God and He will help you walk in the faith of the Son of God so that you can stand against the enemy's tactics.

Faith trusts, hopes, perseveres and receives. Faith never gives up. Faith is the substance of things hoped for and the evidence of things yet not seen. Faith quenches the fiery darts of the enemy. Faith conquerors but it is His faith that we deposit on the inside of us that comes from hearing and hearing the Word of God.

Ephesians 6:16 says to **take up** the shield of faith. **We receive His faith to believe His promises**. Now in order to believe His promises and walk in His faith, we need to know what His precious promises are. As we read the Word of God, we will discover more of Jesus and His Promises for us and faith will arise within our soul. When faith arises, fear, doubt and unbelief are cast out. He gave us His promises so that we will receive them and **take** them unto ourselves. They are free. We don't have to become a Bible scholar but as we take in God's Word and get to know Him the way He really is, our faith in Jesus and in what He has already done for us will come alive. This will cause His faith that is already in our spirit to

arise within our soul. A spiritual shield of faith will arise from the inside of us.

Luke 17:6 "If you have faith as small as a mustard seed, you can say to this mulberry tree, be up-rooted and planted in the sea, and it will obey you."

Think about that. A tree obeying us, yet God's Word says it will. A mustard seed is a very small seed, but when it is planted and watered properly it will grow into a very large tree. I believe God is saying that we don't have to wait until our faith is perfected to be able to receive what we ask for. Even when our faith is only the size of a mustard seed, it is powerful enough to receive from God. However, it can become even more powerful as we receive more and more revelation from God's Word.

I have seen pictures of very large trees after a hurricane uprooted them and turned them over on their side. It is an eye-opener to see the power behind a hurricane and what it can destroy in such a short period of time. God's Word says in the above scripture that if we have

faith as small as a mustard seed, it will be as powerful as uprooting a tree and planting it in the sea. The pictures I saw only showed the hurricane having turned the trees on their side. This scripture says that our faith, even in the beginning stages of its growth, can actually move trees from one place to another **but we need to believe this**. Of course, God is giving an analogy of what faith can accomplish. We may never use our faith to move a tree, but we can use our faith to stand against the enemy of our soul and move sickness, lack, stress, etc. out of our lives. We can also use our faith to trust God to draw us closer to Him, to give us the desire for His Word, to pray through us when we don't know how to pray, to help us surrender to Him as the Lord of our lives, to help us to be led by the Holy Spirit, to give us wisdom in every circumstance that we find ourselves in, etc. When we use our faith, we will stand our ground against our enemy.

Another tactic the enemy uses to keep Christians from using the weapon of faith successfully is to make them think that God's promises are in the future when, in fact, His

promises are already finished and are available to us now by faith.

Too many Christians are praying and asking God for things that God has already made available to them through the redemptive work of Jesus Christ. I did this too but I finally got revelation. I pray that the Holy Spirit will bring revelation to you and that you will walk in the revelation that you are already healed, righteous, loved, forgiven, provided for, anointed, a new creation, etc. If we see a promise in God's Word, it has already been made available to us because of the redemptive work of Jesus. He finished His work on the cross and declared that it was finished. Too many Christians are begging God for things that are already theirs. We just need to receive them by faith. Sometimes when people pray for healing, it is as if it is something that God still has to do in our lives. It is something that will happen in the future instead of something He has already provided in the past. We make declarations of God's promises as if by these declarations God will be moved to make them happen. No. No. No! We make declarations of

God's promises not to get healed but because we believe we are already healed. By our declarations we come into agreement with God's Word that it is already done. This is faith that will move mountains. i.e. I have been healed by the wounds of Jesus. This is past tense, not future tense.

Just like Jesus is our Truth, our Righteousness and our Peace, He is also our Faith.

5. Salvation

Jesus is our Savior.

Ephesians 6:17a says to take the helmet of salvation.

We see two key words here: "Helmet" and "Salvation".

Helmet means encirclement of the head. A helmet is something that is placed on one's head. The helmet of salvation is placed on our head to protect our mind and thoughts from the lies and deception of the enemy. **Lies and**

deception are once again his tactics to keep people from being saved and once saved to try to get them to no longer believe in Jesus as their Savior.

The enemy will use lies to deceive believers and non-believers by saying that God does not love them; that He is not a good God; that Jesus is not God; that the Bible is just a fable, that they can get to heaven by being a good person, etc.

Other lies the enemy uses to attack our mind and thoughts are that we are not really saved. He will point out all of our faults to condemn us; he tells us that we will never make it or amount to anything, and to just quit and give up.

Again, we see the importance of getting our minds renewed with the Word of God, who is Jesus. When God's Word is in our hearts it will come out of our mouths. So when the enemy tries to deceive us by his lies, we can speak out the Truth in God's Word that we are saved by grace through faith in Jesus Christ; that it is not our perfect behavior that saves us but the precious blood of Jesus Christ. The Word of God

will give us understanding and revelation of who Jesus is, what He has done for us and what belongs to us as a child of God. The Word of God will bring revelation of the love of God for us personally and will reveal that Jesus is, in fact, God in the flesh.

Romans 12:2 "Do not conform any longer to the pattern of this world, but be transformed by the **renewing of your mind**. Then you will be able to test and approve what God's will is – his good, pleasing and perfect will." (emphasis added)

When we get our minds renewed with the Word of God, we will know that God is a good God and that His will for our lives is always good, pleasing and perfect. We will no longer believe the lies of the enemy but we will believe the Truth that sets us free from those lies.

There is a battle in our minds. The enemy tries to bombard us with thoughts of fear, doubt, unbelief, condemnation and lies to keep us in bondage to him. These are his tactics. However, when our minds are renewed

with the Word of God, we will not listen to the enemy's lies but rather we will boldly declare God's Word over our lives and our situations.

Reading and studying the Word of God should not be burdensome for a believer. If it is, then ask the Holy Spirit to give you a desire for God's Word and to teach you truth. Ask Him to help you find enjoyment in getting to know God better through His Word.

Getting our minds renewed with the Word of God and believing right is our greatest defense. The Word of God cuts through and tears down the lies and deception of the enemy in our minds. It tears down fear, doubt, unbelief, condemnation, guilt and shame. It brings forth truth that sets us free and enables faith, that comes through Jesus Christ, to arise within our soul.

When we read the Word of God, our minds are getting information and when we put what we believe in the Word into action, faith arises. Belief plus action equals faith.

The other key word is “Salvation”. Salvation is translated “soteria” in the Greek and means saving as well as deliverance, health and wholeness. Yes, wholeness. Often we only look at salvation as being saved and going to heaven. Although that in itself is wonderful, it means far more than that. It also means deliverance, health and wholeness including prosperity in every area of our lives (our physical and mental health, our finances, our marriages, our homes, our relationships, our careers, etc.) All this belongs to us in Christ Jesus.

From the Word of God, we come to understand that in Christ we have an inheritance and we discover our inheritance so that we can receive it and benefit from it. Our inheritance is part of our Salvation. Jesus left us an inheritance but the enemy will try to keep us from receiving it by trying to keep us in ignorance. **Ignorance is another one of his tactics.** Find out what your inheritance in Christ is and receive it. This is taking unto yourself the Helmet of Salvation.

Another tactic is busyness to keep us from reading, studying and applying the Word of God

to our lives. He knows that the Word of God is transforming and life changing and He will try to keep us from getting the Word in our hearts so that it does not come out of our mouth. He doesn't want us to know that we have an inheritance in Christ. **Once we get the Word of God into our heart, he tries hard to steal the Word from our heart so that we don't receive what belongs to us as a child of God.**

Just as Jesus is our Truth, our Righteousness, our Peace and our Faith, He is also our Salvation which includes deliverance, health, prosperity and wholeness.

6. Sword of the Spirit

Jesus is our Sword.

A sword is something we use against an enemy.

Ephesians 6:17b says that the sword of the Spirit is the **Word of God**. John 1:1 says that Jesus is the Word of God. Therefore, Jesus is the sword of the Spirit.

How do we take up the sword of the Spirit? We take up the sword of the Spirit by speaking **God's Word** with our mouth. Since this weapon is to be used against the enemy, we cannot just think it in our mind because the devil cannot read our mind. We have to speak it out loud as that's when it becomes a sword.

Revelation 1:16 describes Jesus in all His glory and it says that out of **His mouth** came a sharp double-edged sword. It came out of His mouth. The Sword (Jesus) needs to come out of our mouth too.

Hebrews 4:12a "For the **word of God** is living and active. Sharper than any double-edged sword." (emphasis added)

In the natural, if someone came at you with a sword and was prepared to use it and you did not have any defense against that sword, you would turn around as fast as you could and take off. The same is true when we use our sword against the enemy. He takes off as fast as he can. He knows he has no defense against the sword, which is the **Word of God**.

Jesus used the sword of the Spirit at the end of His 40 days in the desert when the devil was promising Him things. The sword came out of His mouth.

Let's read that scripture.

Matthew 4:9-10 "All this I will give you", he said, "if you will bow down and worship me." **Jesus said** to him, "Away from me, Satan! **For it is written**: Worship the Lord your God, and serve him only." (emphasis added)

Jesus took authority over satan when He told him to leave. Then He quoted scripture. We are to follow His example.

The following is an example of how to take authority over sickness in your body. I will use pain as an example.

In the Name of Jesus, I take authority over all pain in my body and I command whatever is causing that pain to leave me now. It is written: By the stirpes of Jesus I have been healed."

Did you notice that I took authority and then quoted scripture?

This is how we take up the sword of the Spirit. Just like Jesus used His authority and then quoted scripture to defeat the enemy, we take authority and quote scripture to defeat the enemy in our lives.

The tactics of the enemy to keep us from using the sword of the Spirit which is the Word of God is to lie to us that we don't have authority and to keep us from getting the Word of God in our hearts so that it does not come out of our mouth as a sword.

Luke 10:19 "(Jesus is speaking here.) I have given you **authority** to trample on snakes and scorpions and to overcome all the power of the enemy, nothing will harm you." (emphasis added)

Matthew 10:1 "He called his twelve disciples to him and gave them **authority** to drive out evil

spirits and to heal every disease and sickness." (emphasis added)

Whatever it is that you need to take authority over, find out what God's Word says about it and take up your sword. Speak to that mountain and command it to leave you and then quote His Word and you will stand against the attacks of the enemy in your life.

Just as Jesus is our Truth, our Righteousness, our Peace, our Faith and our Salvation, He is also our Sword.

7. Pray in the Spirit

This piece of the armor is the key to all of the other pieces.

Praying in the Spirit is intercession.

Jesus is our Intercessor.

Romans 8:35 says that Jesus is at the right hand of God and is **interceding for us**.

I believe God intended that praying in the Spirit (intercession) is also a piece of the armor of God. In the New International Version the word "and" links praying in the Spirit with the other pieces of the armor. All the pieces of the armor refer to Jesus including praying in the Spirit. Jesus is our Intercessor.

Jesus was always praying to His Father. Jesus set an example for us to follow. He spent many nights alone with His Father fellowshipping with Him, talking with Him, being empowered by Him, receiving wisdom from Him, etc.

When Jesus ascended into heaven, He told his disciples to wait for the gift of the Holy Spirit which came on the day of Pentecost. All the disciples were filled with the Holy Spirit, spoke in tongues and began to boldly proclaim the Word of God.

Although Jesus is our Intercessor and is forever making intercession on our behalf as He is seated on the throne in heaven, **He sent us His very own Spirit to help us to pray**.

Ephesians 6:18 says to pray in the Spirit

Romans 8:26-27 "In the same way, **the Spirit helps us in our weakness**. We do not know what we ought to pray for, **but the Spirit himself intercedes for us** with groans that words cannot express. And he who searches our hearts knows the mind of the Spirit because the Spirit intercedes for the saints in accordance with God's will." (emphasis added)

If you don't know how to pray about a certain situation in your life, ask the Holy Spirit to pray through you. Then pray in the Spirit with your prayer language until something comes to your mind that you can pray in your natural language. Let Him take over your prayer life. Let the Holy Spirit be in charge. Let the Holy Spirit take His rightful place in your life and in your prayers. He is available to us at all times to intercede through us if we will give room to Him.

James 5:16b "The prayer of a righteous man is powerful and effective."

If we are born again, we are righteous because Jesus has given us His righteousness and our prayers are powerful and effective.

Pray the Word. God watches over His Word to bring it to pass in our lives. Praying the Word is so powerful. The enemy will try to keep us from knowing the Word and, therefore, not be able to pray the Word.

Praying reminds us that the battle of faith is spiritual and must be fought in prayer first. Without prayer, we will not be enlightened when we hear or read the Word of God and, therefore, we will not be able to take up and receive the armor of God. Without prayer, we will not be able to stand against the tactics of the enemy.

When you pray, always pray from a place of victory and not defeat. When you pray, always believe. If you are having difficulty believing that God will answer your prayers, ask Him to help you to believe. I've done this myself.

Ephesians 6:18 tells us that we are to pray on **all** occasions. In order to pray on all occasions, we need to realize that prayer is a way of life. We can be praying as we are on the go. Prayer is talking to God throughout the day and sometimes even during the night. Yes, it is important to set specific times to devote to prayer but prayer doesn't end there. As we go throughout our day with a heart of thanksgiving and praise, we are praying. Praying is communicating with God. Even consulting Him in situations we find ourselves in when we don't know what to do, is prayer. For example, at work if you are faced with a difficult job, ask God for wisdom and His direction. This is prayer. If you can't find your keys, ask God where they are. This is prayer. It is a continual communication with God. Prayer is being God conscious. It is when we have God on our minds and we are conscious of His Presence in our lives. Praise and worship is prayer. Prayer is depending on God and knowing that He is there for us. In other words, we talk to God about everything. We communicate with Him all day long. **Prayer is a relationship with a personal God**.

When we are clothed with the armor of intercession, we will use this weapon to not only pull down strongholds in our own life but also in the lives of others for their freedom. We will intercede not only for our own self but for others as well.

Conclusion:

Each piece of the armor is so closely intertwined because each piece is a part of Jesus Himself. As we fix our eyes on Him, the **Word of God**, and get to know and receive and take Him into our hearts more and more through the **Word** we will begin to understand that He is Truth, that He is our Righteousness, that He is our Prince of Peace, that He is our Faith, that He is our Salvation, that He is the Sword of the Spirit, that He is our Intercessor and that He gave us **His** Spirit who helps us to intercede by enabling us to pray about everything as we yield ourselves to Him. Did you see that the Armor of God is all about Jesus and getting to know Him better?

As we put God's Word into our hearts day by day, little by little, we become the **warrior** that God intends for us to be and we are being clothed with Jesus Himself from the inside out. The armor is available to every believer but we have to put it on and take it onto ourselves. As I said the moment we receive Jesus as our personal Savior and Lord, our spirit man is fully clothed with God's Armor but our soul and body are in the process of being clothed. As our minds get renewed with the Word of God, Jesus becomes so big on the inside of us that we emulate Him. When we are so filled with Jesus Himself, people will look at us and they will see Jesus. When the enemy looks at us, he will see Jesus. That's being clothed with His Armor.

Can you see just how important it is for us to **know** Jesus, who is the Word of God? The Word of God is our inheritance that enables us **to stand** our ground against the devil's schemes.

Isn't it wonderful to know that Jesus loved us so much that He made a way for us to walk in victory? He has given us His Armor so that we can be fully clothed and fully protected. He has

given us His Truth, His Righteousness, His Peace, His Faith, His Salvation, His Sword (the Word of God) and His Spirit to intercede through us.

Why don't you pray right now that God will give you a hunger and a thirst for His Word. **His Word is your inheritance and it becomes your Armor when you get it inside of you.** He wants you to know and apply His Word **so that you can take your stand and walk in victory over all the tactics of the enemy**.